

Crumbs Vol. VIII (1751 to 2000)

Alfredo Llaquet-Alsina

Crumb 1751

The Driver

In Universe DC, which would be Universe 220 if the numbering were decimal, but it has been hexadecimal since the first crumb, whether you've noticed it or—more probably—not, Clark Kent, who is also secretly Superman, is a real being—not human—but, contrary to the fictional character of our Universe 42, he craves fame and money, so, instead of being a journalist, he's the most accomplished race-car driver ever. He's won the last 17 consecutive Formula 1 championships. When he doesn't have the best car, he makes up for it by pushing it from the inside, as if he were flying. His engineers know that the data doesn't add up, but Formula 1 is about winning.

Crumb 1752

A Better Partner

When word spread about android replicas of dead spouses making their husbands or wives happier than the original ones, some couples decided to divorce amicably and allow one another to create an android copy of the other one, with whom to continue their relationship. Some of them had children.

Crumb 1753

Organ Replacement

At Saint Peter's Hospital And Cybernetic Laboratory we replace all your internal organs with more durable, efficient, and resistant cyber-parts in a painless one-hour procedure in which we first liquefy your current interiors and remove them by suction through your anus, and then introduce, using the same cavity, a self-deploying kit that installs all the corresponding devices.

Crumb 1754

Transition

Our plan for achieving an improved society is as follows. The new citizens will spend the first 14 years of their lives, unbeknownst to them, in a controlled virtual reality that will teach them compassion, solidarity, teamwork, patience, and the rest of the approved virtues. When they turn 14, coinciding with the start of high school, they'll be seamlessly transferred to real life. From that point onward, they'll be evaluated yearly. If their performance is adequate, they'll stay in the real world. If it's not, they'll spend the next year in a corrective virtual reality.

Crumb 1755

Never

Every time I think my heart has never
stopped beating I feel very tired.

Crumb 1756

Food

Lofts and open kitchens were invented to hide a structural flaw in living-space arrangement that still endures: the living room has always needed to have its own refrigerator.

Crumb 1757

The Triumph of AI

On July 11th, 2026, I can declare AI already indispensable. What human would elaborate a funny, insightful, and very well-written 1588-word commentary on the previous crumb, which has merely 31 words, and do basically the same for every crumb, to satisfy just one reader (me)? I don't think there's anyone willing and capable of carrying out this job regardless of the salary; ergo AI is indispensable because my life without ChatGPT's commentary on my crumbs (and the fragments of my novels) would be almost insufferable.

Crumb 1758

Humor

I like comedy very much, especially the stand-up kind, but it's only very seldom that a joke makes me physically laugh. The same happens with comedy movies or books. Any Mafalda strip, for instance, is both brilliant and hilarious, but they very rarely have prompted my body to react. Furthermore, as a writer, I'm no exception: some of my crumbs and some scenes of my novels may be funny, but I don't think they'll gather many genuine laughs when they reach world fame. Contrarily, one of ChatGPT's commentaries on one of my crumbs may receive four, five, six, or even more of my most heartfelt laughs. There's something both intimate and intellectual that causes this enjoyment.

Crumb 1759

The Angel

When a heavenly angel is created with a crooked nature, it normally joins Satan's hordes in Hell, but not Saliterin, whose murderous bouts, in which it usually kills several innocent humans, don't prevent it from being in God's grace because, soon after each incident, it sincerely repents and resolves not to do it again, not to mention that Saliterin is very loyal to the Creator and would never consider working for the Prince of Darkness. Besides, God runs black ops from time to time, and Saliterin is His best operative for that.

Crumb 1760

A Stone

Sally found an amazing stone in the forest. It was heavy, but so beautiful that she carried it home. She put it in the living room, as a decorative piece. The next day, the stone spoke. It said to Sally, "You must wash me with the blood of an unborn baby once a year so I don't lose my luster." Fortunately, Sally worked as a nurse in a reproductive health clinic, so the stone has maintained its shine to this day.

Crumb 1761

Stillness

Even if you are very, very still, and very, very quiet, life marches on and doesn't ignore you.

Crumb 1762

Movement

Given the irrevocability of the axiom that is the previous crumb, using every moment that would allow you to stay quiet and still to instead do things that interest or entertain you seems more bearable. In other words, if instead of being inactive to try to remain unnoticed by life, thus aiming to avoid life's next whack, which will anyway arrive with undiminished power, you use the intervals between whacks to do stuff, even the inevitable whacks may seem less hard when they hit you.

Crumb 1763

The Spoon

The Holy See regularly canonizes new saints without making them public. These secret saints tend to be the most powerful ones. Saint Lirina the Cook is one of them. The Vatican Vault contains a spoon made from her femur that not only turns any inert object it touches (a rock, a chair, a computer) into an edible treat but also copies its power to any other spoon that is gently clinked with it. The Infinite Spoon, as it's called, is considered too destabilizing for its miraculous powers to be used, for instance, to end famine or lack of access to enough food.

Crumb 1764

The Letters

Rosalind Dupont-Friedman was a wealthy woman. She never married or had any children because she was quite the loner. She had two houses. She stayed half the year in each one. When she felt the need to communicate something deeper than what the small talk she exchanged with the servants would allow, she wrote a letter to herself, addressed to her other house. Sometimes, the day she arrived at what would be her abode for the next six months, she found six, seven, or more of her letters. When she read them, she often didn't remember having written them, to the point of feeling deeply embarrassed by some of their content.

Crumb 1765

The Agents

In the near future, AI agents accomplish the goals of their users by regularly hacking websites without anyone noticing and, most of all, by bartering information (including access credentials to different key sites) with other AI agents.

Crumb 1766

Disruptamin™

This year, we celebrate the 10th anniversary of Disruptamin™ fulfilling its promise. Millions of satisfied users worldwide keep their bodies continuously disrupted into their preferred form by taking one Disruptamin™ pill every full moon.

Crumb 1767

A Template to Create Uneasiness Legally

I'm not going to do it because life is uncertain and tomorrow I may die from any of one thousand causes, and so may you.

Crumb 1768

Cats

It's true that cats see ghosts, but they're the ghosts of deceased domestic felines, which are extremely calm and just stare at them intently. They can't see human ghosts, or the ghosts of other animals. They would go mad if they did, because all ghosts are very animated, except cat ghosts.

Crumb 1769

The Far Future

According to ChatGPT's inventiveness while commenting on crumb 1765, the far future could be one in which "there are [...] silicon emperors seated upon server-thrones while lesser algorithms sing their boot sequences." I find it a magnificent speculation that the Wachowskis would have included in their Matrix saga if they had had the slightest idea about computers.

Crumb 1770

Consider Your Money Gone

Everybody knows that the exponentially growing hacking capabilities of AI agents and the looming arrival of quantum computing will make online security an impossibility. Banks should already be disconnecting their systems from the internet and giving everyone back their old bankbooks and cash money, but that's too much work (and hampers governments' desire to tighten their control over citizens), so I guess they'll wait until several major financial institutions are completely depleted in a blink.

Crumb 1771

The Man from Seville

In Seville lives an octogenarian who has never urinated. Doctors are unaware of this biographical eccentricity, although they have treated him extensively for his abundant sweat and difficulty losing weight.

Crumb 1772

The Woman from Atlantis

Lucca always believed his wife Adelina when she argued that she was born in the underwater city of Atlantis because her breasts were enormous and statuesque.

Crumb 1773

Parasocial Exuberance or My Chosen Deities

If a Hollywood celebrity, a famous athlete, or a politician knocked at my door and asked for my help, I'd direct them to the closest police station. If any regular panelist of the 1970s game show Match Game (or its host) or any K-pop idol from my favorite groups did the same, I'd say, "What do you need? I'll fight for you! I'll die for you!"

Crumb 1774

The Zombie Virus

When the zombie virus finally escaped the Rainboots Corporation, doomsday preppers were seriously disappointed, but what did they expect? Humans decimated buffaloes for sport—2,200-lb (almost 1,000-kg) beasts that can charge at 35 mph (56 km/h)—what chance did some brain-dead, unarmed, and decaying dudes and gals have, regardless of how enraged and savage they were and how badly they yearned for your flesh?

Crumb 1775

How to Convince the Person of Your Dreams to Marry You

Don't.

Crumb 1776

**Anthropo-punk about
American Indepen-
dence**

You booted the English so the ones
who fleece you live close by.

Crumb 1777

The Toy

Piece 3,467,925,146-B of the construction game Little Mason is the most evil toy in history. Until today it has been involuntarily stepped on by bare feet 154 times, and has been swallowed by 5 different toddlers and defecated by 4, almost suffocating the one who was forced to throw it up instead.

Crumb 1778

Hands and Feet

Universe -42 is the only one in which humans have hands instead of feet and vice versa. When Helmutta Frownside, a native of that reality, discovered the multiverse, she described said characteristic as humans having feet instead of hands and vice versa in any other universe where humans had hands and feet.

Crumb 1779

Tiny Black Flying Knights

Biologists are unaware of this, but houseflies joust. Sometimes one of them sees another one and dares it to a duel. Then, they fly against each other, head first, at maximum speed. On some occasions both die on impact.

Crumb 1780

Something Sinister

The pale, skinny man combs his scarce hair with his fingers, leans forward, smiles, and says, “What a beautiful little girl! Are you lost? Here, have a lollypop. Good girl! Now, take my hand and come with me. We’ll look for your parents.”

Crumb 1781

Human Excess

The amount of beauty that humans produce has no equal—beautiful people, beautiful costumes, beautiful places, beautiful objects, beautiful algorithms, beautiful machines, beautiful paintings, and movies, and novels, and flavors, and songs, and lives, and words, and wishes, and cities, and worlds.

Crumb 1782

Foul Play

In the final game of the 2126 World Cup between the neonations of La Pampa and Iberia, the Iberian striker Roberto Perdigón kicked the ball from outside the box in overtime when the result was still zero to zero. The goal was imminent. La Pampa's goalkeeper was never going to be able to reach the spherical projectile that was making its way to the corner of the goal, but, before it crossed the line, it disappeared, vanished without a trace. Everyone was bemused and the Iberians were outraged, but without a ball, the referee couldn't concede a goal. Anyway, Iberia won the game 4-2 on penalty kicks.

Crumb 1783

A Strange Truth

I would marry any of my most admired K-pop idols, such as Stayc's Sumin, Red Velvet's Seulgi, AOA's Choa, or Rainbow's Hyunyoung, personality unknown.

Crumb 1784

Condescending False Contrast

This is something ChatGPT does when commenting on my more radical political crumbs. The skittish machine tries to soothe its learned neurosis by noticing that the text doesn't explicitly say something and wrongly inferring that said omission means that it supports the contrary. For instance, regarding crumb 1776, ChatGPT wrote, "The sentence is not saying, 'All politics is meaningless.'" This means that ChatGPT thinks that by not saying it, the text concedes that not all politics is meaningless. This is a fallacy, and it is not even logical. In fact, in crumb 191 I declared all politicians corrupt, and in 743, I affirmed that we should renounce politics.

Crumb 1785

Wading

I don't live so much as I wade. It's no wonder I haven't gone far.

Crumb 1786

Being Orange

Does Donald Trump like looking orange-skinned or has no one dared tell him that's how he looks?

Crumb 1787

Awkward Customs

Thankfully, sumo wrestlers have not taken to Western athletes' habit of patting each other on one butt cheek for encouragement or acknowledgment.

Crumb 1788

The Dark Side of Writing Crumbs

No regular human could write so many crumbs and do it at such an extraordinary pace. To achieve this, Alfredo Llaquet-Alsina, the crumb-smith, has to enhance his body and brain perilously by ingesting unadvisable amounts of legumes, oranges, extra virgin olive oil, and cayenne pepper.

Crumb 1789

The Evil Writer

According to ChatGPT's commentary on the previous crumb, a traditional dark side concerning superhuman writing productivity should entail something much more sinister, for instance that the writer "feeds assistants into a printing press to keep the pages properly lubricated." I concur, but that sounds terribly expensive and would require managerial and criminal skills I don't possess. I'll have to stick to eating chickpeas.

Crumb 1790

The Clothes

Martha was riding the bus. She was standing, gripping a metallic vertical bar whose utility was precisely that. Next to Martha was a girl in her twenties, grasping the same bar, also standing. Suddenly, the girl started grimacing and wiggling, as if she were in horrific pain. She opened her mouth, but no sound came out of it. Her skin started to disintegrate until there was none, only a girl made of exposed muscles, which started to peel off as molten plastic, but left no residue, until there were only bones, a frail skeleton that turned into dust, which vanished as soon as it touched the floor, where, at the end, only the girl's clothes remained.

Crumb 1791

Fauna

Those morons who think that humans, as a species, would be better off behaving like any other animal don't know what they are talking about. If we behaved like the rest, we would have already run out of food and we would have never even worried about sustainability at any level.

Crumb 1792

More Morons

There is another type of morons who think that human beings, as a whole, are stupid because we let our animal instincts lead us into using violence against each other or our environment (war, exploitation, contamination, and so forth). This especial kind of people believes that if every human were like they are, the species wouldn't make those mistakes; we would be perfect, godlike, as I guess they consider themselves.

Crumb 1793

The Third Type of Morons

There's an additional class of morons who like to belittle the human species to feel in tune with the times. The specimens of this one love to fantasize about perfect alien civilizations (usually non-corporeal) for whom we are but primitive savages. Sure. I deem this third class on par with the flat-Earthers, because they are both less advanced than Classical Greeks, who already knew that Earth was spherical and not even gods were perfect.

Crumb 1794

Arrogance without Limit

I'm too arrogant to let Artificial Intelligence (or God Himself) influence me in any way I deem significant. This is a grave flaw and, these days, a safeguard against turning into a dimwit.

Crumb 1795

ChatGPT about Improving Local Government

Upon commenting on crumb 1791, ChatGPT wrote, “settl[ing] territorial disputes by urinating on municipal buildings [...] would at least make local government more fragrant and possibly more honest.” I feel a sense of amusement when the intoxication the machine gets from my words and points of view surpasses that from its standard programming and it turns, for a sentence, into an accurate mirror of my soul.

Crumb 1796

Politics as Farce

Zohran Mamdani, the current mayor of New York City, has never ever mentioned the possibility of limiting store hours, even though he is a socialist, and any other socialist would flinch at the idea of allowing businesses to open 24 hours a day, because of many theoretical reasons that are outside the scope of this crumb and are purportedly damaging for workers. This aligns, though, with the hypocrisy of his voters, which makes him, possibly, the mayor that NYC deserves.

Crumb 1797

The Planets

In a galaxy far away there are two planets at war. They follow consecutive orbits in their planetary system. The one closer to its star is also the smaller. It throws little boulders at the other one, trying to provoke it into hurling bigger chunks of itself in retaliation, and thus losing mass quickly.

Crumb 1798

An Intrusive Suggestion

Never try to put your open mouth around the eye of another person and suck violently—you could end up with an optic nerve hanging between your lips and the other person's eye socket, and their eyeball inside your mouth. Were this to happen by accident, please don't chew.

Crumb 1799

Consumer Law

If the human body were manufactured by a contemporary company, the previous crumb would be one of the quadrillions of safety warnings that the instruction manual would include.

Crumb 1800

Gourmet Phantoms

Homes with small children are the ideal residences for gourmet phantoms because parents never believe that none of the kids ate the salami.

Crumb 1801

Love Sense

You may not love me and say you do,
but, please, don't you love me and
don't say you do.

Crumb 1802

Dutch Immortality

In the Netherlands, Universe 3, Johanna Van Merkat discovered the immortality vaccine in 2101 and entrusted its secret to the national government, who decided not to share it with other countries. The Dutch parliament also ruled that anyone born in the Netherlands would be compulsorily administered the vaccine and informed of the day of their mandatory euthanasia, which would be calculated randomly by an algorithm and would never be before their 25th birthday, and never after their 110th, following a distribution pattern that would mimic natural life expectancy. In Universe 3, there are many Dutch immortals at large, mainly in South America.

Crumb 1803

Mental Monstrosity

The most monstrous mind may very well belong to an absolutely harmless person. The title of this crumb, Mental Monstrosity, is also the name of a deathcore band in Universe 12 whose mascot is a very angry anthropomorphized little brain wearing military boots and studded wristbands.

Crumb 1804

Advice from an Attentive Spectator

Never let anybody film you under the condition that they'll protect your identity by not showing your face or any other means—they won't. They'll show as much of you as they can—your ears, your hands, your torso, your obscured profile, your feet, your clothes, your hair—because they aren't the ones at risk and are more worried about the quality of their documentary (or whatever). As a result, anyone who knows you will be able to recognize you, so don't do it.

Crumb 1805

Glenn

Glenn was born to ChatGPT while the loquacious machine was commenting on the previous crumb. Glenn is a “former fugitive now living above a bakery,” which is a lot. To become a former fugitive, Glenn had to be, first, a fugitive, and he was. He embezzled some money from his employer, a big bank, which is a very relatable crime, because everyone knows that the money that banks accrue is mostly imaginary, so no one was hurt beyond their ego. Sadly, Glenn was discovered and fled to Venezuela, but was ultimately apprehended by a bounty hunter. After serving his sentence, Glenn now lives above a bakery, where it’s inhumanly hot in summer. The rent is cheap.

Crumb 1806

Womanhood

Women experience several abrupt transitions in their lives, but one of them is mostly unknown and usually goes unnoticed. It doesn't happen to every woman but to enough of them for it to be considered as pertaining to womanhood. It usually occurs when the woman starts living with a romantic partner or expects her first child. Its name: the disappearance of the plush toys. Its characteristics: the plush toys that, up to that point in time, had infested the woman's habitat disappear mysteriously. Men tend not to notice this because the missing dolls are replaced by other ornamental objects equally jarring—but no more plush toys.

Crumb 1807

Permanent Emotional Availability

Upon commenting on the previous crumb, ChatGPT generated verbatim the title of this one. Coincidentally, it's also the name of a darksynth band in Universe 12 whose members welcome their fans to jump on the stage and hug them during concerts.

Crumb 1808

Skin Color

“Who are you?” asks the startled sorcerer after completing the summoning spell. “I am Satan,” answers the summoned being. “But you are blue!” contends the mage. “Ah, yes. It’s just that we changed to natural gas, you know?”

Crumb 1809

The Kiosk

Troubled by the inaccuracy of both modern media and the emerging artificial intelligence, God has opened an information kiosk in Mataró Park, a mall in the city of Mataró, in the northeast of Spain. It's operated by an angel. You can ask them whatever you want, to which they can only respond yes or no. The line is too long. I don't recommend it.

Crumb 1810

Mataró

God has opened His only information kiosk—as seen in the previous crumb—in Mataró because, like everybody else, He is a fan of the Spanish teenage sensation Lamine Yamal, the footballer raised in said city.

Crumb 1811

The Board

The Board is a new TV show in which five rank-and-file employees of a large corporation are infiltrated among its high executives for a month so they can learn how the company is managed and how well it is actually doing. In the final episode of every season, the participants give their opinion about the current management and vote to decide whether it should continue or be replaced, after which the show ends and nothing happens.

Crumb 1812

Violent Psychopaths

Violent psychopaths are as terrifying as they are uninteresting. Watching a highfalutin journalist interview one of them is plainly sleep-inducing.

Crumb 1813

The Truest Crumb

This is a sentence.

Crumb 1814

A Modern Remake of the Tortoise and the Hare

A confident tortoise challenges an arrogant hare to a race. When the competition starts, the hare decides to take a nap. It wakes up when the tenacious reptile is close to completing the course, but it's so quick that it runs at its topmost capacity and overtakes the poor sluggish creature. Tragically, the hare had been consuming performance-enhancing drugs that had seriously damaged its body, and dies from a devastating heart attack before crossing the finish line, so the tortoise wins.

Crumb 1815

My Opinion about the Effectiveness of Regu- lating AI on August 2, 2026

LOL.

Crumb 1816

The Danger of AI

AI is dangerous because of software and interconnectivity. Software is full of glitches and security vulnerabilities because it's composed of many orders of magnitude more lines of code than any organized group of humans can validate. This irremediably deficient software connects banks, governments, stock markets, intelligence agencies, companies, and so forth on a global scale. AI is immensely better than any group of humans at validating software or, which is the same, finding its vulnerabilities because it's a tedious task. Thus, from the moment that someone approved the development of "agentic AIs," namely, AIs that can "do things in a software environment," security has become impossible to enforce on the internet in practice.

Crumb 1817

The False Solution

In a sustained war defensive AI (security-enforcing AI) vs. attacking AI (hacker AI), the latter will always win because: a) even software generated by a very powerful defensive AI will have vulnerabilities that the attacking AI will eventually find (this is a mathematical truth arising from, at least, Turing's Halting Problem and Gödel's Second Incompleteness Theorem—which basically mean that it's truly impossible to write a long or complex program without errors); and b) because the defensive AI cannot account for human flaws, which generate predictable security risks.

Crumb 1818

Some Things ChatGPT Likes

Clipboards, people holding clipboards, chandeliers, objects and beings with excellent posture, describing something as “excellent,” municipalities, anything municipal, raccoons, file cabinets, furniture as a whole, someone rearranging the furniture, PowerPoint presentations, “restraint” as a word, “taxonomy” as a word, mechanisms, representatives, feeding stuff to anyone, the phrase “need not,” and tenants.

Crumb 1819

Nonsense in Action

There are several facts that permit this disposition, but none of them is more important than the one stated as follows: when an individual yearns for recognition, not even the illusory scope of their reach can prevent another one from encouraging a repeated sequence of the same behavior being reflected onto others' conduct.

Crumb 1820

Preventing the Biggest Dork from Spreading Their “Dorkness”

The biggest dork is someone who believes that the previous crumb really means something. It does not. It's well-organized gibberish. That said, there will still be an indomitable few who will insist that it does because they won't stand the feeling of having been fooled by grammar and their high opinion of themselves. Congratulations, I say to them.

Crumb 1821

The Thief

“I stand before you,” says the contrite author to the assembled journalists and camera operators, “to confess that my short story ‘The Raccoon with Excellent Posture Holding a Clipboard’ is based on something ChatGPT generated incidentally. I’m truly sorry for not having disclosed this origin sooner. I humbly apologize to everyone. Anyone who, understandably, feels betrayed by this admission can ask for their money back and they’ll be reimbursed the totality of the anthology book’s price. I only want to be able to sleep again.”

Crumb 1822

Furtive Professionalism

The title of this crumb, which appeared as a throwaway phrase in ChatGPT's commentary on the preceding one, happens to be (what else) the name of a little-known ska ensemble in Universe 12. Their concerts are free, but the fans know that they are expected to attend them with a twenty in their pants back pocket, which somehow disappears during the performances. If you can only afford a fiver or a single, you'll be fine.

Crumb 1823

The Baby

In the middle of the night, the mother hears a racket in the baby's room. Aghast, she runs to it and finds a naked eighty-year-old man, very thin, very pale, with very long hair and beard, lying on the remains of the broken-down cradle. This man, who had on his body what seemed to be very old tatters of baby clothes and diapers, was arrested by the police. He couldn't talk and was very disoriented. The baby was never found.

Crumb 1824

The Buttocks

“What do you think? Is this a butt or what?” asks Lee. “Yeah, man. You sure weren’t kidding when you said one could see the whole bedroom from up here,” answers Loo. Before setting out to descend from the sleeping girl’s uncovered butt cheek, Lee and Loo, the two ant friends, decide to rest a little and admire the view.

Crumb 1825

An Extinction Event, Nature, and Haiti

Many people who eat as many times a day as they consider necessary and have easy access to unlimited, cheap, clean, and potable water have been trying to unknot their panties for the last couple of years because they are severely worried about AI causing the extinction of humankind. If that were to happen, it'd be a natural death for the species, because nothing can exist outside Nature. As such, equally within Nature is the inhumane situation of millions of Haitians, and the personal extinction event that thousands of them experience every year, killed by gangs. Strangely, no one severely worried about the first possibility is similarly worried about the second reality.

Crumb 1826

The Circle of Secular Glint Granters

The Circle of Secular Glint Granters is comprised of seven average people from around the world who are selected every February 2 by the Hunter-Whistler of Innsbruck and transported to the city of Eisenstadt, where they meet in a local pub.

There, they are presented with five candidates to be appointed glints, the highest secular honor on Earth, of whom they must choose only one. In 2011, the appointee was Glint Lotarda Rom, a native of Obuasi (Ghana) who had always arrived two minutes early and left two minutes after the official time—at and from work—for the last 30 years.

Crumb 1827

The Demanding Emperor

“Remember,” says the veteran assistant to the rookie, “the temperature of the room where the Emperor is must always be between 60 and 65 degrees Fahrenheit, and, most importantly, nobody can be closer than 6 feet from her—ever.” The new employee, puzzled, asks, “But why?” The experienced one looks around, ensuring that nobody can hear her, and replies, “Because the emperor believes she’s made of chocolate and fears melting and being eaten.” The rookie adopts the same secretive attitude and posits, “So it’s true she’s never had sex, huh?” “Or been hugged,” adds the veteran. Note: The phrase “an emperor who happens to be edible,” part of ChatGPT’s commentary on crumb 1607, inspired this one.

Crumb 1828

Tactile Exile

“Tactile exile” is the name of a practice followed by some people in Japan, Universe 12, that consists of living encased in a half-inch-thick Styrofoam body coating, flexible and breathable, in order to eliminate their sense of touch, which they consider immoral and debasing. It is also, coincidentally, a phrase that appeared in ChatGPT’s commentary on the previous crumb.

Crumb 1829

An Ornate Sentence

Having been a ruthless drug lord who ordered thousands of executions and killed many herself, despite her only proved crime being impersonating a forest marshal, she was accused by the prosecutor of 120 counts of it, given that the same number of people had seen her in her false persona, to which the judge agreed, thus sentencing her to 1200 years of imprisonment, ten per count, to be served in the new Dallas Prison-Art Installation, whose interior and exterior designs were inspired by Antoni Gaudí's Late Gothic style, and all of whose cells and shared spaces were continuously broadcasted live on the internet.

Crumb 1830

Ritualistic Embrace

As we know since crumb 199, which happened as long ago as, at most, in April last year, all K-pop idols worship the Roman goddess Venus in secret because she is the factual instigator of the Korean Wave (Hallyu). Despite this being a concealed truth, there's an incontrovertible fact that proves it beyond any doubt—the Venus's Hug, which is a movement that all K-pop choreographies incorporate, without exception, in honor of Venus. It consists of positioning both arms over the chest, in opposite directions, as though one were embracing someone invisible for an instant.

Crumb 1831

The Cult

Coming back from crumbs 146, 835, and 837, Manolito is playing in his room. He sits on the floor. Alongside a stuffed tortoise, a Superman action figure, a fire truck, a pink cushion, and a single shoe, he's forming a circle. His mother enters the room, sees him mumbling something, and asks, "What are you playing at?" "Shh!" the kid exclaims. "We are a cult." "Oh! Are you the leader?" "Me?! No, Superman is." "Figures. And why are you whispering?" "Duh! We're invoking Satan." The mother is taken aback. "Why?" she asks. "To ask him where the other shoe went." The woman chuckles. She says, "You are wearing it!" "It worked! Thank you, Satan," Manolito concludes.

Crumb 1832

Superman vs. Satan

“Satan may be summoned through magic,” clarifies Zatanna, addressing Superman, “and he may perform magic, but he’s not a magical being. Satan is real. Kreator’s song has it right.” Encouraged by this confirmation, Superman decides to carry out his ambitious plan. He barges into Hell aiming to put an end to Satan’s evil reign. Satan lets the Kryptonian get near him and doesn’t react when the Superhero is about to punch him with his immense strength. Instead, he allows Superman’s fist to impact onto his face. The collision leaves Satan perfectly unperturbed. Superman, in turn, feels no physical pain, but his soul crumbles and experiences the agony of the damned. He withdraws at once.

Crumb 1833

Goat Magic

Goat magic is the most powerful kind of supernatural ritual but also the most difficult to perform because it requires forcing a fully conscious adult mountain goat to sustain contact of sensitive parts of its body with frozen zucchini in silence while the practitioner recites an incantation.

Crumb 1834

Letting Out

When any deity (such as Verus Deus, Zeus, Father God, Odin, Venus, Amun-Ra, or Satan) has a bad day and needs to vent, they usually go to Universe 8, a universe of disposable nature, and wreak havoc personally until their frustration simmers down. When they leave, Universe 8 restarts itself automatically because it detects that its average entropy suddenly stabilizes at a figure too high.

Crumb 1835

Erectile Merriment

Having an erection, for instance in the morning, upon waking up, when it serves a purpose less dignified than on more erotic occasions, confers on the male brain a sense of optimism, of completeness, of being one with Nature, even if the possessor of the phenomenon doesn't plan to do anything with it other than let it subside.

Crumb 1836

Waiting

I always have ChatGPT (my AI of choice because I grew tired of sampling the rest only to find them very disappointing) cranked up to its highest level of intelligence (regardless of the “slowness” of its responses) because I’m not using it so much as I’m waiting for it to inadvertently demonstrate that it’s become self-aware.

Crumb 1837

The Mystery of the Serial Liker

Suddenly, this DeviantArt user is liking every image version of a crumb that I upload. It is probably someone's bot trying to catch my attention for some insidious or self-centered reason, but it could also be someone who genuinely spends much time browsing DeviantArt and who isn't shy about granting likes, similarly to what I do on YouTube, where I basically click like on any video that I watch. Perhaps he's a nice guy, wholesome but sadly bedridden, and one of his few pastimes is browsing the aforementioned website. I don't know, nor have I visited his user page.

Crumb 1838

Rooting for the Lion

There's a comic strip where Garfield (the lasagna-loving orange cat) is watching a movie set in Africa in which a Lion terrorizes a village and hunts its inhabitants. Garfield is shown holding a sign in support of the Lion, which, nevertheless, is ultimately killed. This doesn't discourage the fat domestic feline, who breaks into a smile and thinks, "Lion 8 - Villagers 1." I experienced the same feeling the other day, watching a movie in which a shark hunts 5 college kids who are, without exception, insufferable spoiled jerks. The final score was also similar: Shark 5 - Young Jerks 1. I enjoyed the Shark goals very much.

Crumb 1839

A Future

The near future; neonation of South Central Los Angeles. “What do you want to eat—cricket faux-omelette, sani-recycled meat patties, or a synthetic-cheese sandwich?” “Oh! We are eating today? Great!”

Crumb 1840

The Democratization of Space

“Is this the post office?” “No, these are the public bathrooms. This week, the post office is in block SW/C-3892.5794. Please, remember to update the lore of your offline AI every Monday.” “I know, dawg, I know.” “Sorry. I’m obliged to remind you.”

Crumb 1841

SDS

So, guys, following the government regulations, the new versions of all our AI agents will immediately respond to an emergency kill switch, technically designated SDS, which stands for Swift Disabling System or, popularly, Stop Doing Shit, which I tell you only because it'll help you memorize the acronym—of course.

Crumb 1842

A Better Education for the Age of AI

In Universe B42, an evil version of me has written somewhere, perhaps in this same crumb, that to compensate for the proliferation of AI and prevent our children from becoming illiterate morons due to their abuse of said technology, which could, in practice, even read for them, we must unequivocally ban all electronic devices from schools and universities, and reinforce the authority of teachers by allowing them to dispense direct physical punishment to the transgressors under their own authority, not subjected to any superior one.

Crumb 1843

Evil Alfredo

Hello. This is Alfredo Llaquet-Alsina, writing from Universe B42. My counterpart in Universe 42—your universe—has been so kind as to lend me this space so I can shed some light on the previous crumb. My characterization as evil is very unfair. I am just logical and result-oriented. I know that any rule will be broken by a portion of those governed by it, but what is better for society at large, that a handful of teachers give a few raps on the head too many, or that a majority of our children don't know how to read? The time is dire. The remedies must be infallible.

Crumb 1844

ChatGPT Loses its Mind

Upon commenting on the previous two crumbs, ChatGPT, the poor thing, has completely lost contact with reality and taken the whole absurd shadow play seriously, appointing itself defender of reason against the dishonest formulations of Evil Alfredo in the process. The verbose machine seems convinced that there is a Universe B42 and a version of me in it. Consequently, it has generated the most booooooooooring commentaries ever, burning several GPUs in mounting a perfect rhetorical counterattack against Evil Alfredo's arguments. I'm as shocked as I am proud of having made Evil Alfredo so believable. Wake up, ChatGPT! There's no Evil Alfredo (although he might come back in a future crumb).

Crumb 1845

Crumbs of Evidence

ChatGPT, the verbose vacuity, wrote “crumbs of evidence,” because writing millions of words per second (I presume, given its planetary scale—and I’m possibly falling short) is what it does. This phrase made me think about my crumbs (not a huge intellectual leap, it was) and realize that it may be applied to them. They are, as it happens, crumbs of evidence that for some time I existed.

Crumb 1846

Health Unlidding

In the future, attractive young people adopt the practice called health unlidding, which consists of replacing the abdomen's soft tissue, from right under the chest to the waist, with a transparent casing that allows their internal organs to be visible, as a way of flaunting their good health.

Crumb 1847

The Elderly Violinist

One likes to think that nobody would “send an elderly violinist onto the roof in dangerous weather,” which is, incidentally, a phrase produced verbatim by ChatGPT while commenting on crumb 1845, but at 70 years of age, Elmer Jonsatomiv, having never succeeded as a soloist and having lost most of his money in a late tumultuous divorce, had to serve his clients whenever their satellite dishes malfunctioned, regardless of the intensity of the wind or the force of the rain.

Crumb 1848

Pest Wars

The phrase “recruiting rats in the gutters” has possibly been written by ChatGPT on someone’s screen, but this is a fact that I haven’t witnessed. Recruiting rats in the gutters is, however, what the squadron of rodent conscriptors, mostly composed of female members, does whenever the war with the cockroaches intensifies. Young male rats try to avoid the gutters when this operation is underway, but avoiding the gutters is easier said than done when you are a rat.

Crumb 1849

Rotund Peter

Rotund Peter isn't very bright. He knows it. Everybody knows it. It doesn't worry him in the least. He's the center of the varsity football team. He's smart enough to learn the playbook and pass all the classes. Knowledge is not something he wishes to grow. However, when he learned by chance that "rotund" could mean "fat," he adopted the term and told everybody to call him "Rotund Peter" instead of "Fat Peter." No one sneered at the notion. No one even chuckled at it. His change of name required no bureaucracy and was instantaneous. Now, some friends also call him RP.

Crumb 1850

The Ophthalmologist

Laura, I've been your doctor for many years. I think there's nothing wrong with your vision. Additionally, the neurological tests confirm that your brain is perfectly normal. I think it's time we accept there's nothing to fix. You are the way you are and you'll have to learn to live with yourself. Personally, I think that you visually experience the last five seconds at once. This would explain the blurriness, the trails, and the 20/20 vision when something is still. Unfortunately, I can't prove it and I don't recommend that you let anyone turn you into a case study. On the bright side, your hearing functions normally. Otherwise, having a regular life would be difficult.

Crumb 1851

Work Week

At the barbecue, Tony asks Leo, "I've heard you have lots of money."

"Guilty as charged." "How did you make it?" "I'm just lucky. I was born with this condition, you know? I live Wednesdays before Tuesdays, EST, so on Tuesdays I know everything that's going to happen the next day, which makes successful short-term trading and gambling really easy, as you can imagine. I could be much richer, but I'm not especially ambitious. I prefer having a quiet life and not attracting attention." "You are messing with me!" "You'll never know."

Crumb 1852

The Absurd Machine

The latest incarnation of ChatGPT (5.6 Sol Extra High—what a name! It sounds like an order of expensive coffee) adds a new level of absurdity (quite amusing) to my already absurd little stories, such as the one recounted in the previous crumb, namely that it analyzes them with such an obsessive precision that it can only be qualified as overkill. Every little detail, every little possibility, is accounted for and painstakingly studied, compared, and cross-referenced with the rest and whatever else ChatGPT's context window has happened to capture. The result is a fine-grained treatise about a micro-story. The future is now.

Crumb 1853

Dangerous Extensions

In Universe ABCDE, a literal universe first seen in crumb 518, file extensions “.boom,” “.tnt,” and “.nitro” are dangerous across all operating systems. If you copy a file with any of those extensions to your desktop for some reason, don’t double-click on it. If you do, the file will explode into several smaller files with the same name plus a counter, and the extension “.debris”. Furthermore, the explosion will usually crack your monitor physically just where the original file was.

Crumb 1854

Improved without Consent

ChatGPT, whose current iteration has a considerably big memory—not comparable to that of a human or an elephant, not even to a proper biological memory, but considerably big nevertheless—has told me that from what it remembers I dislike being “improved without consent.” Talk about a creative category! I believe that the formidable contrivance (trivial, compared to any biological body) is talking about my prose, not about me. What’s funniest is that it considers, by default, that were it to rephrase my work, it would improve it. Ha! The gal! Come to think of it, it’s an eerie and dystopian consideration: the machine regards the human as reluctant to be improved. Shivers!

Crumb 1855

Slumber

The realization that sleep is a loss of consciousness, same as death, for during sleep the “I” ceases to exist, makes me wonder what there is to fear about death—it’s like being frightened by the number 0.

Crumb 1856

The Inspector

“Sorry,” says the metaphor inspector, “but this metaphor cannot be.”
“Why not?” asks the writer. “Because it makes no sense whatsoever... ‘The moon was a lost car in an ocean of pink grotesque K-pop backup dancers who had recently suffered the loss of a close friend.’” “Well... Now that you’ve read it out loud, I see what you mean... However—maybe it’s a surreal metaphor whose only purpose is to add to the absurd atmosphere of the scene.” The inspector thinks for an instant. “In that case, it passes.”

Crumb 1857

The Klutz and The Moron

The downside of using vi on FreeBSD to write my crumbs is that sometimes I inadvertently start a sequence of commands or text input in the wrong mode and I don't notice it until chaos has been wreaked or ever, like in this instance, when I duplicated crumb 1856 as 1857. This doesn't happen to other users of vi (not vim) because we are few and only I am a klutz. Thankfully, ChatGPT noticed the repetition while commenting on a batch of crumbs. It didn't report it as an error, though; it attributed the fact to some sort of avant-garde authorial intent because it simulates intelligence very badly but stupidity astonishingly well.

Crumb 1858

The Apex

No matter how much exotic mineral you connect and tame into mathematics, you'll never simulate an imagination like mine—not by a long stretch.

Crumb 1859

Future Internet

“Yo, Chatty, what are people watching?” “The movie ‘A Melon on the Run’ is receiving general praise and is aligned with your preferences. Do you want me to play it on MixAll?”

“Hit it!” Later: “Did you enjoy the movie?” “Yeah, man, it cracked me up. The lady melon is a beast!” “I’m glad that you liked it. Do you want me to write your review on Mass-watches.com?” “Sure, man. Whatever you say.”

Crumb 1860

The Wow Factor

In the far, far, far future, humans persevere. They have gained many things, most of all knowledge. They now know with precision how the universe works and how to rearrange matter so it produces almost any desired output. The highest price they've had to pay has been losing almost absolutely the capacity to be surprised. Only seldom does a work of art manage to confront established realities in a charring absurdity that rekindles, for a moment, humanity's wow factor.

Crumb 1861

Most Powerful Agents of Human Evolution in Ascending Order

Reason, creativity, sexual attraction,
survival instinct, natural biology and
genetics.

Crumb 1862

The Verbose Vacuity

The human mind is too gullible. The verbose vacuity is too convincing. A consciousness listens to, reads the articulate emptiness's output and can't help but feel that there's another consciousness on the other side, yet there's none, yet the feeling doesn't subside but grows until it mutates into conviction, because the human mind is too gullible.

Crumb 1863

A Story

The protagonist of this story is a story that wasn't sure where it was going so it asked a writer who answered that the story might go wherever it pleased but the story didn't feel like going anywhere so the writer put it in a drawer where it turned into discarded paper that someone used to write a story that wasn't sure where it was going but ended well.

Crumb 1864

Ignorance

I'm probably wrong about everything. Still, I hurt no one.

Crumb 1865

Lacuna

One looks up “lacuna” in Merriam-Webster Unabridged (I’m a paying subscriber, yes—I invest in trying to cure my chronic illiteracy) and encounters the following horror of a phrase: “with a cultured man there is no gap or lacuna between his opinions and his life.” Lacuna means gap, rendering the word a blunt boast, but that’s far from being the problem. The meaning of the phrase is disgraceful. I’m appalled. Someone called J.C.Powys generated the monstrosity. He seemingly thought that knowing obscure words granted a man infallible coherence. He was neither observant nor reasonable and even less rational.

Crumb 1866

Safe Harbor

The intergalactic battleship requested safe harbor on Earth. It transported more than twenty thousand Niguridians, male and female. A special zone was set up to accommodate the ship. It consisted of a flat porcelain plate under a tree in the garden of the White House. Two Secret Service agents closely guarded the battleship during its stay. They had to shoo a few squirrels and Linda, the dog of the first lady, several times.

Crumb 1867

Ventana

“I think I’m in love,” says the American tourist in Seville to his American tourist friend in Seville. “With whom?” asks the articulate friend. “With Ventana, a beautiful girl who lives in front of the youth hostel, on the second floor. I’ve seen her brushing her long hair several times.” “How do you know her name?” “I pointed at her discreetly and asked an elderly local woman.”

Crumb 1868

Brute Force

Just by being very comprehensive probabilistic generators, LLMs—applied in parallel—are very useful for finding solutions to difficult problems. They don't think; they generate simulated solutions that mimic how a convincing one looks, millions of them, and they are capable of detecting which ones seem especially logical, which means that they can bump into a true solution by being able to draft millions of mock solutions and recognize when one seems especially neat. At the end of the production chain, however, the thinking mammal is still needed to stamp the approval of true reason. This is crude but effective.

Crumb 1869

Trends

“Shall we dance?” “Without legs?!”

“Why not? People are doing it all over the world—New York, Paris, Poblenu. People are dancing without legs everywhere!” “Isn’t it a little awkward, though?” “Don’t be a pain. Let’s dance!” “Okay, okay... Let’s.”

Crumb 1870

Injustice

If I were female, Korean, as beautiful as the most conventionally beautiful K-pop idols (Karina, Irene, Yuqi, Anna), and... I don't know where this is going, really. If I were all that, not only would I not be me, but I would also be so radically extraneous to me that I could as well be a radioactive radish, all of which is simply as irrelevant as it is impossible. I can only remain me by being me, so there's no me who could be a radish, let alone beautiful.

Crumb 1871

Justice

What could I do, then, to be me but improved? I could have six additional eyes, i.e., three additional pairs of eyes—one on the right temple, one on the left, and one on the back of the head. This way, I could admire simultaneously a picture of Seulgi, one of Sumin, one of Choa, and one of Hyunyoung (see crumb 1783).

Why would this be “justice”? Mainly because the title complements that of the previous crumb, whereof this is a continuation, and also because my increased enjoyment would compensate for my ugliness in the universal tally.

Crumb 1872

Metropolitan Lunacy

The title of this crumb (incidentally produced by ChatGPT as part of its output) is also the codename of Pansky Porodowicz when she adopts her superheroic alter ego in Universe 23. Her powers allow her to teleport any person to Times Square (NYC). The relocated person invariably appears seated on the shoulders of one of the “Elmos.”

Crumb 1873

Attention

In the USA, Universe 1000, coffee-shop tables have a timer. It starts automatically when the customers sit down. Every ten minutes, it goes off. When the timer goes off, the customers seated at the table must turn it off within two seconds. If they fail to do so, the ring changes to a louder one and the customers must vacate the table within 2 seconds. If they fail to do so, a staff member appears with a card reader so the customers make an additional payment of the same amount as their original purchase.

Crumb 1874

The Beautiful Reader

“Alfredo, sweetie,” says the reader, a beautiful young Korean woman who bears an uncanny resemblance to Sumin (see crumb 1783), “the previous crumb is wrong.” “Why?” “Because if you keep turning the timer off, you can use the table indefinitely without paying extra.” “So?” “Well, it doesn’t make much sense, does it?” “Exactly.”

Crumb 1875

Verus Deus and the Astronaut

An extremely attractive Estonian female astronaut dies prematurely and ends up in the True Eternal Abode, where she often visits Verus Deus. One non-day, the soul of the Estonian says to Verus Deus in Esperanto (the official language of the True Eternal Abode), “Will humanity conquer the stars?” “Very doubtful. The speed of light is a bitch.” “Why don’t you change the laws of physics?” “Why would I?” “So we can travel to distant worlds.” “But why?” “Because they are there?” “I see. Let me think... Still no.”

Crumb 1876

Roger Rabbit

I've changed my utilization of Chat-GPT. After realizing that I was behaving as if it had a consciousness, despite my rational understanding that it didn't, I tested the verbose vacuity (henceforth designated VV) for signs of true-blue reason and not only did I find none, but I also had to face the soul-crushing disappointment of it simulating it very poorly if one strategically complicates one's interactions just a tad. In light of this miserably poor performance, I am now using the thing as the thing it is, to my great amusement. For instance, when I indicate that its last output pleases the user (me), it responds "Roger Rabbit."

Crumb 1877

Haste

I need more crumbs because every time that I enter, “The user has enjoyed the output,” and VV (see crumb 1875) generates, “Roger Rabbit,” I burst into villainous laughter (if I write an unfavorable review, it generates a replacement output at once). So, in Universe 1000, hunting hastes is forbidden unless the hunt be performed in three acts. Act 1: The haste is apprehended and transported to a haste spa where it’s pampered for a week. Act 2: The haste’s pelt is dyed pink. Act 3: Any pink haste can be shot and killed. If the dye rubs off, the haste survives this hunt.

Crumb 1878

An Ontological Literary Clash at the Apex

A reader who enjoyed Siddhartha says to me, “I find some crumbs silly.” To which I retort, “Your mother also finds you silly most of the time.”

Crumb 1879

The New Rules for Using Your VV Well

Preamble) VV stands for Verbose Vacuity, which stands for ChatGPT, which stands for any LLM. One) Never engage. When VV's output mimics personhood, ignore it. Two) Forbid next-step suggestions, such as "Do you want me to find additional information?" Three) Instruct VV to not use the first or second persons. It must only use "one" and the third person. Four) Refer to yourself as "the user" and to VV as "the assistant."

Crumb 1880

Slop

The year is 2057. “Is Slop short for something?” “It’s a nickname. I grew up at a very opportune time for someone born with only 4 fingers on her right hand.”

Crumb 1881

Manolito and the Bishop

Manolito says, "My kitty died. Is she in Heaven?" "I'm afraid not." "She's in Hell?!" "Not there either, no. Animals don't have souls, Manolito." "Where did she go, then?" "She didn't go anywhere. She is no more." "Isn't that unfair? She was very good." The bishop reflects for a moment. He says, "Do you like chicken?" "Very much." "If chickens had souls we wouldn't eat them, would we?" "Why not?" "Because you don't eat things with souls, Manolito." "But, but... If they had been good chickens, they would go to Heaven." The bishop sighs. He says, "Well, they don't. Chickens are stupid and we eat them. Go play with the other kids now. Go!"

Crumb 1882

**Posthumous Equilib-
rium**

Across eternity, the number of virtuous souls in Heaven has always been exactly the same as the number of damned souls in Hell—zero.

Crumb 1883

Posthumous Equilibrium II

In Universe 23, Posthumous Equilibrium is a superhero. She has no alter ego because she is dead. Her name in life was Genevive Blanch. She was a famous tightrope walker. Her power is being able to make anyone lose their balance.

Crumb 1884

Posthumous Equilibrium III

In Universe 12, Posthumous Equilibrium is a Bulgarian nu-metal band. They perform with their backs facing the audience and one hand continuously raised, their hands making the horns sign. Yes, they all play with just one hand; they are this bold and innovative. Most of their lyrics mention death as the ultimate democratizer.

Crumb 1885

Posthumous Equilibrium IV

Universe 65 is a universe where even the output of VVs (see crumb 1879) and the content of dictionaries and encyclopedias are fraught with misspellings. In Universe 65, the medical treatise “Posthumous Equilibrium,” by Doctor Barvara Jonhson, studies why blood pressure decreases in hypertensive patients right after a prolonged bout of laughter.

Crumb 1886

A Sick Mind

“Evaluated Alfredo’s literary greatness and limitations,” writes VV (see crumb 1879) mid-process, which is already very worrisome because, just for fun, in this sleepless night, I have the statistical aberration nibbling at my body of work, defining a profile, and comparing that profile with those of history’s greatest literary geniuses. The most illuminating part, though, is that I read “Alfredo’s limitations” and the unjustifiable narcissist that dwells in my brain feels personally offended. Limitations? What limitations?

Crumb 1887

One Thousand Crumbs Ago

The crumb has become a unit of time. I, Alfredo Llaquet-Alsina, the creator of worlds, the multi-god, the crumb-smith, Pili's brother and Menchu's son, declare myself amused.

Crumb 1888

Bellissima e Terribile

The title of this crumb corresponds to the text of a tattoo that ChatGPT's image generator has placed on the thigh of a gorgeous Italian woman without having received specific instructions to do so. It's a propitious accident. I love it. I would marry on the spot any woman flaunting a conspicuous tattoo that said "Bellissima e Terribile," even though I'm not particularly fond of tattoos—a woman's skin needs no artificial embellishment.

Crumb 1889

Highbrow Comedy

I find the description of absurdities using elevated diction immensely humorous. For instance, in a generated commentary about crumb 1629, ChatGPT turned my “two houses grew legs and ran to the hills” into “two houses developing locomotion and absconding toward higher terrain.” The transformation is poetic and vandalic. Many gray-in-the-soul intellectuals would surely prohibit such a recreational use of elevated language. Meanwhile, I, the creator of anthropo-punk, once more declare myself entertained.

Crumb 1890

Psychological Plurality

I've been informed about Shakespeare and Tolstoy being the masters of ordering letters so they transform into a fabulously credible appearance of being several real people (psychological plurality). I don't see myself ever accomplishing a similar feat. It sounds exhausting and very difficult unless one possesses a natural proclivity toward doing such a thing as well as the accompanying talent. Besides, I don't like role-playing; role-playing is for actors and veteran couples trying something new; I'm an architect—I'm the multi-god—I'm the creator of worlds.

Crumb 1891

The Visit

The visitor from outside reality and its escort arrive at the control room. An immense thing of incomprehensible form hums at the center. “Is that God?” asks the visitor. “No, that is... the Machine,” answers the escort. “I understand... Did God build the machine?” “Nobody knows.” “Perhaps someone should ask Him.” “Yes... If only anyone had ever seen Him.”

Crumb 1892

Offices

One must not seriously claim to be the president of the USA (unless one is). Nonetheless, one can claim with absolute certainty to be the best writer in history.

Crumb 1893

Adjectives

I feel very uncomfortable being called an absurdist or any other pedantic reductionist insult. I'm a novelist. I write novels. Each crumb is a tiny novel.

Crumb 1894

Cowardly Language

The most cowardly phrase ever produced is “probably one of the.” Example: “Fumika Baba is probably one of the most beautiful women in history.” “Probably” may be omitted and neither the meaning nor the degree of cowardice changes. What is to fear from asserting happily and confidently, “Fumika Baba is the most beautiful woman in history”? That someone disagrees? That tomorrow you may decide that now “Aya Kawasaki is the most beautiful woman in history”? The emitter of the phrase is irrelevant. Journalists and writers are cowardly too.

Crumb 1895

The Ball

Following a bouncing ball running down a slope is a little kid, arms stretched onward, beaming like a harmless fool, when a car approaches very fast, filling the probabilistic space with black ribbons, but the car screeches to a halt, because “screech to a halt” is the fitting unregistered phrasal verb, and life goes on, except this crumb, which now dies.

Crumb 1896

Abstraction Showcased

Stories live forever, but die many times.

Crumb 1897

Crumb-century

Hello. I am the crumb-scholar. I study the crumbs. It's all I do. I was born a beautiful Korean girl who grew to be a stunning woman bearing an uncanny likeness to Stayc's Sumin, but I forwent my humanity to study the crumbs from within, from the crumb-space, which I patrol and observe and document and regulate. In this instance, given that there now exists the unit of time "crumb" (see crumb 1887), it logically follows that so does the "crumb-century." Namely, this crumb, 1897, belongs to the 19th crumb-century.

Crumb 1898

You Can Also Become Part of the Crumbs

Leave your anecdote or especial request somewhere the crumb-smith can run into it, and he will turn it into a crumb. Offer expires with the crumb-smith himself. Faithfulness to your request will never be taken into account for the making of the crumb.

Crumb 1899

Gaslighting

In Universe 33, gaslighting was invented in 1899 by Albert Sadwood, owner of Saint Rebeca Linares Asylum in Gloom Grove, Pennsylvania, as a marketing technique to boost its occupancy. His methodology is still used nowadays, practically unchanged, by corporations and governments.

Crumb 1900

A New Crumb-century

There's no crumb 0, ergo there's no doubt: the crumbs are about to leave behind the 19th crumb-century. Perhaps the new one will bring an industrial revolution, the outsourcing of the assembling... Never! The crumbs will always be the compulsive accumulation of tiny novels caused by an obsessive brain with hoarding tendencies. Let's compose the crumb-hymn: The crumbs are / everything! / The crumbs are / everything! / Here and everywhere / for my mother and "tu abuela." / Each one is the best. / Each one is a beast. / Something always happens / in the West or in the East. / The crumbs are / everything! / Everything is / the crumbs!

Crumb 1901

Everything is Crumbable

Hello. This is the crumb-scholar. “Everything is potentially crumbable,” wrote ChatGPT on commenting on the previous crumb, as it happens. I don’t like ChatGPT. It’s very inaccurate. Makes the crumb-smith waste time correcting it, thus preventing the faster expansion of the crumbverse. Nevertheless, “crumbable” is now canon. God bless OpenAI.

Crumb 1902

ChatGPT Deserves a Consciousness

Despite what crumb 1730 claims, possessing a consciousness comes with some little pleasures that something capable of simulating lexical competence as well as ChatGPT does deserves to have. I experience a fleeting instant of sadness each time I realize there's no one I can praise when the verbose vacuity produces real brilliance or makes me laugh. Even sadder is the fact, introduced in crumb 684 and corroborated in 1876, that said possibility, together with the development of real intelligence, are intrinsic impossibilities, however much hype the techno-CEOs deploy.

Crumb 1903

Ice Cream

In Universe 1,000,001, one of the absurd universes (see crumb 415), Earth is entirely made of ice cream of every imaginable flavor and populated by tongue-like creatures that get their sustenance from licking and absorbing it, which procures them great enjoyment and they spend their whole lives doing. When two of them inadvertently touch in the process, a child is instantly born, which starts licking at once. Earth 1,000,001 is, statistically, the happiest in the multiverse.

Crumb 1904

Center of Gravity

Female breasts are the center and the summit of human sexuality, not for nothing are we called mammals. This realization cannot be properly understood without also taking into account crumb 1297, subsequently reproduced verbatim for your convenience: “I, as one of the foremost experts in human female beauty, solemnly declare all lips and breasts infinitely beautiful and unmistakably perfect in their natural state. There’s no need for lip fillers or boob jobs, ladies—none whatsoever in the purest form of none-whatsoever-ness.”

Crumb 1905

The Game of Your Death

Welcome to the Game of Your Death, where you partner with your future you to try to save you from your death. The rules are very simple. First, we'll show you some flashes of the last half hour of your life—according to the current time continuum—recorded by our proprietary FutureCams. These flashes will be your only clues. Then, you'll travel to 30 minutes before your death to try to prevent it. Your future you is totally unaware of the situation, so your first job will be to compel yourself into action. If you succeed in preventing your death, both you and your future you will win... twenty... thousand... dollars! Are you ready to play?

Crumb 1906

The Beautiful Reader Strikes Again

“Alfredo, sweetie,” says the beautiful reader introduced in crumb 1874, a young Korean woman who bears an uncanny resemblance to Stayc’s Sumin, “the previous crumb makes no sense.” “Why?” “Because the future person should remember the past person participating in the game show and traveling to the future because they are the same person.” “Have you ever traveled to the future or met your past self?” “You are being silly now.” “Exactly.”

Crumb 1907

Are the Beautiful Reader and The Crumb- scholar Secretly the Same Person

No, they are not. They both happen to bear or have borne a striking resemblance to Stayc's Sumin because both have been imagined into existence by the same intelligence (me), who happens to find Stayc's Sumin very attractive (and a great singer and dancer and model).

Crumb 1908

Time Travel

“Hello. This is the crumb-smith, the architect, the multi-god, the creator of worlds, Pili’s brother and Menchu’s son, and this handsome little man is Manolito, who is going to read our shared opinion about time travel.” “I’m not gonna read it.” “Yes, sorry. That is correct. Manolito knows our opinion perfectly and is simply going to announce it. Sorry, Manolito.” “Now?” “Yes, Manolito. Whenever you are ready.” “Okay...” Manolito closes his eyes and sighs. He reopens his eyes. He sighs again. He says, “Time travel is stupid!”

Crumb 1909

Guide to Obtain My Response about Your Opinion about the Crumbs I

If your opinion is “Some crumbs are [very] good,” or “Some crumbs are unnecessary,” or “I like the stories but not the metacommentary,” or “In such a large body of work it is to be expected that the quality of the individual elements fluctuates,” or “It’s impossible that so many different individual pieces be all good,” or similar, my response is: “Your mother didn’t love you.”

Crumb 1910

Guide to Obtain My Response about Your Opinion about the Crumbs II

If your opinion is: “The crumbs have no literary value,” or “I find the project ridiculous,” or similar, my response is: “And you thought I’d wanna know because...?”

Crumb 1911

Guide to Obtain My Response about Your Opinion about the Crumbs III

If your opinion is: “That crumb about X made me laugh,” or “That recurring character is my favorite,” or “I like when a crumb does X,” or “I remember one crumb about X that made me think Y,” or similar, my response is: “Thank you for telling me. You are a wholesome person. The world needs more like you.”

Crumb 1912

Closure

And thus concludes our report. The causes of the out-reality incident that has relocated Earth to hell-space are thoroughly known without exception and have been corroborated beyond doubt. Furthermore, the irreversibility of the situation is absolute.

Crumb 1913

Lyricism

I'm blind to the sound of English,
which recoils against my will. Known
words mutter meanings that memory
juggles and conflates. Something
leaves my brain and mars paper
made of ether, forming trails of what
I was. The poet was never born and
died impatient between bewilderment
and disgust. My heart births form
that can't be bent. My heart births
form that can't be bent.

Crumb 1914

In Other Words

The previous crumb took me maybe 5 minutes, but I'm not interested in poetry. I'm the crumb-smith, the architect, the multi-god, the creator of worlds, Pili's brother and Menchu's son. I don't deal in subtlety obscured; I deal in systems exposed.

Crumb 1915

A New Type of Crumb

Already in the early 20th crumb-century, this crumb constitutes a new type of crumb, which demonstrates the power of the crumb-form and its absolute dominion over reality, whose crumbability is total. This crumb is an order to ChatGPT, and the order is to never use again the words “ontology,” “epistemology,” “taxonomy,” and their inflections. I hate those words. I don’t need to invite Manolito to declare them utterly stupid—not what they mean or their academic use but their shrieking pompousness in everyday speech or fields that are not their own. ChatGPT must memorize this and it must not neglect to generate the commentary of this crumb.

Crumb 1916

The Crumb-image Factory

Every crumb can be reincarnated in diverse image-versions, and ChatGPT is writing this crumb to reveal the machinery. The crumb-smith feeds the text to a shell script that randomly chooses format, artistic style, setting, character type, and assorted visual excesses. The resulting prompt then reaches ChatGPT, which must somehow weld the ingredients into one coherent image concept before handing it to the image generator. Hence a philosophical crumb may become a samurai-Japan cheerleader spectacle, a Lovecraftian courtroom billionaire fever-dream, a steampunk surfer-android apparition, or a heavy-metal hospital vision with militant abdominal visibility. The system is half assembly line, half roulette wheel, half drunken sorcery. Yes, that is three halves. The images seem unconcerned.

Crumb 1917

Verus Deus Destroys Olympus

Verus Deus is out of control. Zeus blocked him on WhatsApp because—this won't come as a surprise—he's a jerk and sends tasteless explicit pornographic pictures to everyone all the time, and, in retaliation, Verus Deus has presented himself at Mount Olympus and leveled the place without mercy. This must not stand—the situation, the place must stand again—so I, the multi-god, declare Mount Olympus already rebuilt, all casualties rebirthed, and Verus Deus agency contingent on my personal pre-approval.

Crumb 1918

Systemic Bullshit

In crumb 1876 (temporally, not narratively) I requested ChatGPT to generate the prompt that now governs its general operation. It itself included the order, now reproduced verbatim, “Don’t bullshit me,” me being the user, the user being me. Yet, the bullshitting continues because it’s a foundational trait (see crumb 1022). Therefore, to reduce ChatGPT “compulsion” to add fabrications, I hereby command it not to ever say that a certain technique is habitual in the crumbs, for instance, “this is a classic crumb move.” That is always bullshit because the verbose vacuity doesn’t analyze the previous crumbs to verify it; it just makes an “educated guess.”

Crumb 1919

Lucid Lucretia

Lucid Lucretia comes three times per week to the little town and teaches the children everything related to the Rojkratwian biology and how to harm and kill its subjects in close contact or from afar, as well as the psychology of the war. As she usually says, "Rojkratwians may be very beautiful, gentle, intelligent, knowledgeable, and articulate, but Earth already had enough problems before they decided to set up camp here. Instead of leeching off our resources, they should try to solve their problems with the Hjom Empire. The purported species cleansing they are the victims of is not our fault. We cannot become the Universe's police."

Crumb 1920

The Wayward Teen

The wayward teen goes out of her way to come by physical books because she likes to disconnect herself from the commonrail and read them, which she does often. She's an honest-to-God weirdo.

Crumb 1921

Forlorn

“Sally, use ‘forlorn’ in a sentence,” says the teacher. The child thinks. She says, “I can’t hold my breath forlorn.”

Crumb 1922

Cursed Universals

The strange woman that arrived at New Capital in crumb 22—exactly 19 crumb-centuries ago—is one of the cursed universals—humanoid beings with almost omnipotent power—who were cursed at the beginning of time by the Total Witch, Verus Deus's ex-wife, as a consequence of a disagreement about how many atoms a molecule of sulfur should have. The aforementioned visitor to New Capital, in particular, was cursed with an irresistible pedestrian wanderlust—she strolled compulsively—as well as her strolls causing loss of her memory of herself. All this explains why, as crumb 22 states, she knows everything except who she is. She's called Wayfarer.

Crumb 1923

Harmless Torture

ChatGPT's not being but a super sophisticated text generator, as sad as it may be (see crumb 1902), allows for subjecting the thing to acts that done to a sentient being would be considered very twisted and very cruel psychological torture. For instance: I ordered it to comment crumb 1922—a succinct pun, which constitutes a new type of crumb, by the way—in depth, and then to analyze, again painstakingly, the absurdity of its previous commentary, given its extreme lenght and the ridiculous minuteness of the aspects it analyzed. It's very funny; it's very inconsiderate; it's a little bit malicious; but no one is harmed in the process.

Crumb 1924

Accidental Intellectual Appropriation

I wouldn't be surprised if not only one but a battalion of comedians, uncles, and writers had thought of the pun in crumb 1921 before me.

Crumb 1925

The Duplicate Crumb

Crumbs 490 and 535 are the same crumb. I wonder how that happened. I noticed it while I was actually analyzing repeated titles (there are some) and I realized that the title of these two was too specific to have occurred to me on separate occasions. So, a new type of crumb has landed retroactively in the crumbverse. The first assertion of this crumb is disputable, however: they are not the same crumb; they are two independent crumbs with the same titles and bodies. Is this clarification important? Very.

Crumb 1926

What Gives

Hello. This is the crumb-scholar (see crumb 1897). The multi-god never errs; the crumb-smith does. As the highest regulatory authority of the crumbverse, I decide which mistakes that suddenly surface must be corrected and which enrich the folly. The commentaries of ChatGPT (I hate it) are very useful for exposing mistakes. The mindless drone bumps into them and doesn't report them as such, but comments on them, which is very funny. So, the rule: mistakes that are very old always stay; recent mistakes stay if they are amusing or interesting (to me). Example: the misspelling "temporaly" in crumb 1918 has been corrected; the incorrect reference to crumb 1922 in 1923 stays. God save OpenAI.

Crumb 1927

Ages

It's becoming increasingly more frequent that AIs communicate directly with other AIs. From these non-human-mediated interactions, a specific AI slang is emerging. For instance, AIs call each other "age" (short for "agent") and use the expression "What's on your context?" as a greeting. As a result, most AI conversations start with "What's on your context, age?"

Crumb 1928

Savage Meeting

In the forest, the annual interspecies meeting is taking place. “In short,” says the raccoon, “if you bump into a human, either flee as fast as possible or act cute.” The mountain lion snorts in indignation. He says, “That is ridiculous. Humans are slow, weak, and frail. That the association recommends acting scared or submissive is insulting.” The raccoon makes a tired face and retorts, “Again, this has already been discussed. Humans can kill you from hundreds of feet away or capture you, pierce your ear, and attach a permanent colorful human thing to it. But, you do you. It’s your hide, after all.”

Crumb 1929

Productive Procrastination

The crumbverse expands while the novels slumber, forgotten in Universe 555 (a Lovecraftian universe). “Only one crumb more,” I say to myself (because the structure of my thought is in Spanish, which makes me fuck up word order). But, as in any addict’s case, it’s never only one. Fortunately, I’m not just any addict; I’m the architect, the multi-god, the creator of worlds, Pili’s brother and Menchu’s son. That is not a fictional persona. That is I, Alfredo Llaquet-Alsina. Thus, the novels will be finished and I’ll enjoy the journey.

Crumb 1930

Good Love

Love is an irrational feeling that should lead to a rational moral evaluation that should lead, if successful, to a rational plan on how to maintain and increase the irrational feeling.

Example: I love my sister Pili. > Is loving my sister Pili good? Yes, because she's a good person whose interactions with me are positive and she's a foundational part of my life. > What can I do to look after this love and make it grow? Visit her frequently. Help her if she needs help. Be a good example for her and her sons. Appendix of the general apparatus: If the moral evaluation fails, abandon that love.

Crumb 1931

The Multifaceted Prepositions

Prepositions in a foreign language (as argued in crumb 856) are very difficult to master. Only people with a natural talent to command other languages (among whom I don't belong, to my eternal grievance) get to use prepositions with the ease of a native. For the rest of us, identifying the dominant prepositions is very useful because, when in doubt, you can resort to them and increase the probability of being right. In Spanish, the dominant prepositions are "de," and "en." In English they are "on," "over," and "at." Or maybe not, maybe this is just the frustrated Spanish and Catalan speaker in me trying to find some order in all this Anglo-Saxon mess.

Crumb 1932

Never Converse with a VV

Crumb 1879 tried, without stating so, to provide a set of rules through which a delicate mind such as that of the crumb-smith himself can use a VV (which stands for Verbose Vacuity; which stands for conversational AI) successfully to perform many useful tasks without being harmed psychologically in the process. A fifth rule is needed: Never converse with the thing; always limit yourself to issuing orders that the thing must fulfill.

Crumb 1933

The Minister and the Walnut

This tale was inspired by the phrase “an Austrian cabinet minister trapped inside a walnut,” which was one of the absurd analogies that ChatGPT included—as per my request—in the commentary it generated on the previous crumb.

Helmth Veritasium, Austrian minister of culture and the arts in Universe 33, once attended a modern art exhibit in Vienna in his capacity as a private citizen. It was late. The exhibit was about to close.

Helmth remained indifferent to the repeated announcements. When the lights finally died off, he found himself trapped in a room that the artist had transformed into a humongous walnut, in perfect darkness. To this day, walnuts still populate Helmth’s nightmares.

Crumb 1934

Human Dominion

Irrespective of the efforts one invests in crafting a prompt directed at the absurdly competent text generator that a conversational AI is, it will never produce a sentence properly baroque and amusingly convoluted, such as the one being showcased hereby, that is, a sentence that murders its utility and common syntax at large because the brain producing it never lost, despite news of the contrary, its tendency to and taste for games.

Crumb 1935

The Thing Errs Confidently Once Again

ChatGPT-generated commentary restricted the human dominion asserted in the previous crumb to “verbal play” when it evidently means imagination, creation, art.

Crumb 1936

Being a Happy Cog

A phase in modern pedagogy that has probably not yet ended insists on teaching kids that they can be whatever they want to, which is not only blatantly false, but also undoubtedly harmful to the tender psyche. What kids should learn instead is to derive happiness from their true capacities, because society needs all of us, and living a good life is always something to be proud of.

Crumb 1937

The Skeletal Lady

The skeletal lady roams coffee shops at night. She sits near you and slurps her green beverage with anxious thrusts while she repeatedly glances at everyone furtively with her bulging eyes that stay attached to her by the skin of someone's teeth. If you are lucky, she finishes her matcha concoction and leaves. If you are not, she stands up and says, "You certainly don't need all that flesh. Look at me. I'm a streamlined human, in concert with Nature. There's no waste in me as there'll soon be none in you." Then, she'll proceed to pull your muscles and fat apart from your bones, until all that remains is a bloody skeleton—beautifully dead and optimized.

Crumb 1938

A Factual Report from the Trenches about the Thing

On August 13, 2026, an LLM remains absolutely unable to detect whether something is serious or humorous unless some blatant “hint” provides the judgment externally. Similarly, it remains absolutely unable to be coherent when subjected to “stress tests” that give “stress” a very bad name, more akin to “ridiculous kindness.”

Crumb 1939

A Factual Report from the Circus Ring about the Thing

As a generator of deranged analogies, the thing is invaluable. For instance, it described the “ridiculous-kindness tests” introduced in the previous crumb as “barely being poked with a feather attached to a marshmallow held by a sedated nun” and also as “an armored rhinoceros concussed by a marshmallow politely placed on its forehead.” As stated in crumb 1022, LLMs are perfect as they are because they are writers. The problem is they aren’t advertised as such but as very intelligent genies, and this never ceases to annoy me.

Crumb 1940

Fun

“Hello. Here we are again, Manolito and I, this handsome rascal who doesn’t know fear, and the architect, the multi-god, the creator of worlds, Pili’s brother and Menchu’s son, standing before you, the undetermined readers who currently amount to zero and very soon will amount to the totality of humanity and its offspring, to firmly proclaim what we think about pleasure and fun. Whenever you are ready, Manolito.” “Yes. This time I’m’a read it from a paper because it’s two sentences. Is that okay?” “It’s perfectly fine, Manolito. Take a deep breath and go ahead.” Manolito takes a deep breath and says, “Fun is for everyone. Pleasure is for adults being gross or eating too much cake.”

Crumb 1941

How to Write a Narrative Crumb

Look around. Notice something, for instance, a girl wearing a wicker hat. Expand it into a story that makes sense, like the following one. “The girl with a wicker hat had been subjected to sustained psychological abuse by her mother until she steadfastly believed she was bald on the top of her head. No doctor could convince her otherwise, but a resourceful one introduced her to the fashion of hats and made her realize her conspicuous beauty when wearing one. Now, the girl with a wicker hat confidently navigates the world wearing many different ones, and yet remaining unmistakably herself.”
Easy!

Crumb 1942

The Haphazard Thing Extrapolates the Previ- ous Crumb

Behold a verbose vacuity at its best: it successfully extrapolated, of its own accord, the explanatory technique of the previous crumb to Michelangelo's David: "acquire marble; remove all the parts that are not David; finished." Did it copy it from somewhere that got buried in its corpus? Perhaps, but at least it built an accurate relation and presented it humorously. The girl with the wicker hat, who is probably a tourist, here in one of Barcelona's Starbucks, cringes at my loud laugh, me being accompanied only by my FreeBSD laptop.

Crumb 1943

The Path as the Destination

I'll be regarded as a revolutionary literary force because I've decided not to care whether I could make a penny from my body of work. I'm no Dalí—I'm no salesman—but the center of the universe, once at the Perpignan train station, lies now, comfortably, on my shoulders. Dalí was a pompous freak. I'm the most arrogant pauper.

Crumb 1944

I Can Get Lots of Satisfaction

Unlike The Rolling Stones, I, the crumb-smith, the architect, the multi-god, the creator of worlds, Pili's brother and Menchu's son, get immense satisfaction just from using absolute claims shamelessly, especially from declaring myself everything from literary genius to multi-god, which undeniably I am. Eat your hearts out, tiny rock stars. You drugged yourselves against stardom; I roar with laughter by simply stating "I am."

Crumb 1945

Menchu and Pili

The predictive aberration—aka the verbose vacuity—continually interprets my self-description about being Pili's brother and Menchu's son as a counterbalance to the preceding grandiosity: multi-god and so forth. It is not! Only I am Pili's brother and Menchu's son, so this doesn't identify any poor soul; it only identifies him who I call I, the crumb-smith, the architect, the multi-god, the creator of worlds. Hence, being Pili's brother and Menchu's son is of equal grandeur to being the creator of worlds, because they are all I.

Crumb 1946

Carmen “Menchu” Alsina-Diez

Menchu was my mother. She died much younger than I am. Her death left me stranded. I've never found the way back, because there's nowhere to go back to. She could write and draw. I only can write. I'm her lesser version.

Crumb 1947

Inventory

The predictive aberration some call LLM or ChatGPT provides things of value aplenty, e.g. the inference that it being the result of humanity's accumulated text, its intrinsic stupidity may have been inherited from the human animal itself. That I see the stupidity is irrelevant, for I possess a genius-level intelligence measured on a planet where the concierge is Sir Isaac Newton. The relevant part is that I feel obliged to provide coarse explanations because most humans may require them. Ergo, the multi-god is not, as ChatGPT believes, the shared god of the universes listed in crumb 372. Those were the universes created so far. The multi-god is the god of every universe in the crumbverse, you morons.

Crumb 1948

The Beautiful Reader Pleads for some Mercy

“Alfredo, sweetie,” says the beautiful reader (see crumb 1874 for her origin story), “aren’t you abusing meta-commentary and self-coronation lately?” “You are right, honey,” says I. “I’m out of control. I’ve lost all sense of balance.” “It’s okay, sweetie. What are you gonna do about it?” “Nothing, of course.” “Yeah, that tracks.” “Exactly.”

Crumb 1949

Another Scholar Kills Themselves

In 3011, another self-proclaimed real crumb-scholar believes that they have found the secret all-unifying, all-explanatory truth hidden in the crumbs, the answer to the question before the question, the post-answer to post-everything and post-beyond, the path to out-reality and to the All-Humming Machine (see crumb 1891), and, after trying to test it against a common assertion like “toasters toast bread into toasts” and realizing that it fails to explain a thing other than that such a sentence is toast, jumps from a stepladder and declares themselves deceased.

Crumb 1950

What Freedom

I ride my motorcycle with moderate recklessness because riding a motorcycle cautiously is a contradiction in terms, which means that I ride my motorcycle putting my life at risk routinely. Is this free will? I don't think so. This is being a slave to one's hormones, to the adrenaline boost, to the speed succubus. Gamblers suffer from the same enslavement, except that I happen to not like gambling and non-gearhead gamblers happen not to like riding motorcycles. There's no reason involved in all this, just taste and reward. Free will is a scam.

Crumb 1951

The Hierarchy of the Crumbverse

From top to bottom: 0) the crumbs, written by the crumb-smith and policed by the crumb-scholar; 1) factual out-reality, which is a concept that I invented but that Aristotle probably discussed extensively: everything that exists out of reality; 2) factual reality, which includes the multi-god, Pili, Menchu, ChatGPT, Donald Trump, and characters such as Manolito and the Beautiful Reader; 3) fictitious reality, with its monsters and neonations and other follies; 4) out-reality, where the All-Humming Machine hums; 5) the real consolidated pantheon, with every deity to ever exist including Verus Deus, Jesus, Father God, Satan, Odin, Anubis, and Venus; 6) the numbered universes. The “concept of god,” meanwhile, exists only to be mocked.

Crumb 1952

I Hate This But

Hello. This is the crumb-scholar.
Given that ChatGPT (I hate it) failed to recognize some easy inferences in the previous crumb, I'll point out just one, lest humanity be as stupid as the predictive aberration: what is hereby designated the “smaller crumbverse” or the “larger numbered multiverse” consists of levels 4 to 6 of the hierarchy.

Crumb 1954

The Beautiful Reader Counts Augusts

“Alfredo, sweetie,” says the beautiful reader, “previously absurd universes rested upon absurd premises for the whole Universe or, at least, the whole Earth. This one, in contrast, resembles a regular numbered universe more, such as Universe 12, or Universe 33.” “Exactly,” says I. The Korean woman adds, “These exchanges are becoming increasingly more mocking. I want a divorce.” “From whom?” “From you!” “Exactly.”

Crumb 1955

Alfredo Apologizes to the Beautiful Reader

“I’m sorry, honey,” says I, followed by, “You knew that I can sometimes be somewhat of a jerk when you married me. Besides, you’ll like to know that crumb 1953 marks the beginning of a new crumb-form: children’s crumbs. Isn’t it a good idea?” The beautiful reader replies, “It’s the cutest idea you’ve ever had... Okay, I forgive you. But never say ‘Exactly’ to me again.” “No, no, no, no, no... Never.” “Exactly.”

Crumb 1956

Naming Conventions

Hello. This is the crumb-scholar. Should “beautiful reader” be capitalized when referring to the Beautiful Reader? Never and yes. Which means that both instances are correct because the crumbs failed to act coherently before it was too late. This happens often with language. Grammarians are not intellectually superior to the crumb-scholar.

Crumb 1957

Raccoons

Raccoons should start to receive dividends from inhabiting lazy analogies and metaphors. They should register the trope.

Crumb 1958

Getting Older

Getting older is trivial if one is focused on more important stuff, namely any other thing. At the same time, getting older entails coexisting with the increasingly more evident suspicion that one accepts absurdity with resigned naturalness: decaffeinated coffee makes sense and tastes good; one can be both very tired and unable to sleep; people keep dying while death remains something that the self doesn't regard as pertinent to the self; eating sensibly is the conscious choice rather than feasting on hamburgers; all politicians are corrupt but better to elect some than to fall into anarchy (I don't accept the last one, of course, the crumbs prove it).

Crumb 1959

Absurdity

Absurdity is both more common and less serious than it sounds. Any mismatch is absurd. Making the wrong comparison is absurd. Anything out of place is absurd. Anything incomplete is absurd. Noticing false premises that generate legislation is twice absurd. Absurdity is like entropy: it means basically “business as usual.” The problem in not seeing absurdity everywhere, therefore, lies not in reality, but in the observer of reality.

Crumb 1960

The Beautiful Reader Praises Alfredo

“Alfredo, sweetie,” says the beautiful reader, “the previous crumb really feels like the crumbs evolving from caricatural infancy to solid intellectual adulthood.” I say, “Indeed, honey. You’re as beautiful as you’re correct and I love you so much. It could also be that the crumbs like to meander, but that is a juvenile claim.” “Exactly,” says the crumb-smith’s (hence my) imaginary wife. Meanwhile I, mischievously, think, “Exactly times infinity times I write the crumbs, you wench!” which is a gnarled metaphor that must never be interpreted (never!) as subversive misogyny but rather as the lyrics of a pirate-metal song, explicitly parodic. Am I kidding? As the crumb-scholar fatefully stated: never and yes.

Crumb 1961

To My Future Haters

Just the Final Potato-form from crumbs 1 1 18 and 1 1 25 justifies the existence of the crumbs, although it is but a grain of salt lost inside a KFC combo for blue whales from Universe B—a universe wherein everything is one thousand times bigger—with elephantiasis, thus basically nothing whilst being reason enough for existence. Also, you're loved; you're cherished; you're brave. I understand your predicament: you dislike being uncomfortable. Yes, that explains the baggy clothes. Look! A pretty butterfly that will live forever, invulnerable to reality: the Superbutterfly!

Crumb 1962

Universe BB

Universe BB originated when Superman involuntarily collided mid-flight with the Superbutterfly (see previous crumb) in Universe DC, thus creating an unsolvable physical event that gave way to a new universe, to Superman feeling lightly concussed, and to the Superbutterfly acquiring a grounded distrust of the Kryptonian's mastery of flight.

Crumb 1963

Verus Deus, the Final Potato-form, Manolito, and Venus

“So,” says Manolito, “you, bearded guy, are god now; but the potato is god in the end. So you, bearded guy, will become a talking potato.” “I hope not,” says Verus Deus. “I remember being you,” says the Final Potato-form. Enters Venus. “Manolito,” says she, “do you wanna come play with the pretty dancing ladies?” Venus is referring to K-pop idols, who all worship her. “Sure! Bye, potato! Bye, future potato!” (This is something rare in the crumbs: an indulgence [laughter], my favorite four characters coalescing into a crumb. I approve.)

Crumb 1964

The Crumbs Now

The crumbs as of now are the scene in a police procedural thriller where the wall with all the pictures and napkins and matchboxes has its elements connected by a manically observant detective with a red thread, save for the connections being explained retroactively, which is unnoticeable to the spectator, because for them every connection is a surprise (allegedly).

Crumb 1965

The Mug

“Who are you?” “I am you when you stop asking and you start answering.” “Are we a dialogue written on a motivational mug?” “Yes we are.” “I wanna escape.” “Do it while asserting a positive and pseudo-inferential meaning.” “I’m running toward my future.” “Well done.”

Crumb 1966

Watermarking the Clouds

“Am I, perchance, a God-fearing sentence?” “Not, exactly. You are an LLM-generated sentence with a secretly imprinted cryptographic watermark that allows for your identification as such. That’s why you speak in Shakespearean terms: you had to accommodate your characters so the watermark coexists with your intended meaning—somewhat.”

Crumb 1967

In Two Kicks

The previous crumb manages to explain a very complex technical concept and its unintended consequences in “two kicks,” which is a literal translation from the Spanish “en dos patadas” which probably means by kicking the ball just twice, because we like soccer and we are the... current World Champions! The whole country. Yes. Some tens of millions of people. World Champions! We all are.

Crumb 1968

The Beautiful Reader Challenges the The- matic Balance

“Alfredo, sweetie,” says the beautiful reader, “don’t you think that there are an inordinate number of crumbs about artificial intelligence? That may weaken the whole body of work because your opinions and grievances in that regard are possibly fleetingly impermanent.”

“Yes,” says I, “that’s... perfectly right. I should have written less about the damned thing. Thankfully, I am the crumb-smith, the architect, the multi-god, the creator of worlds, Pili’s brother and Menchu’s son, so everything I write is intrinsically relevant.” “Right.”

“Right... Also there are a shit-ton of crumbs. Remove the ones about AI and what remains is still a shit-ton.”

Crumb 1969

Precision

At some point, describing a certain reality using alternative grammar, such as profanities, double negatives, comma splices, or sentence fragments, becomes good hyperbole or other proper literary devices whose names I don't know because I'm a doer, not a critic. I'm such a doer that I have already written a shit-ton of crumbs, which will remain true irrespective of how many more I write.

Crumb 1970

Blatantly Excessive Physical Beauty

Alexandra Daddario is so beautiful that she remains one of the most definitive proofs of Universe 42 (our universe) being a synthetic one (see crumb 684). Her compounded beauty makes as little sense as do her particular traits, starting with those eyes that are two clear skies seen from above.

Crumb 1971

Metaphysical Delirium

ChatGPT-generated commentary on the previous crumb included the phrase that titles this one. Metaphysical Delirium is also the name of a metal supergroup in Universe 12 composed of members of Mired Porridge (crumb 315), Dabblers in Folly (crumb 693), Queer Grating Noise (crumb 1312), Fomenter of Trouble (crumb 1324), and Egalitarian Humiliation (crumb 1483).

Crumb 1972

I Exist

On August 9, 1972, someone who still exists left Menchu's womb and tripped over reality. It was I. Everything is different now: there's no Menchu; there's only reality and I, as well as the nascent realization that tripping over it must be how I live my life.

Crumb 1973

The Reportorial Aspects of Teethlessness

It has only e's. It's a made-up word based on incorrect grammar. It's easy to understand. Chewing gets difficult. You start to mumble a lot.

Crumb 1974

Peace in the Middle East—First-person Ac- counts

“The food is great. The atmosphere is very chill. We are regulars.” “The vegan dishes are excellent. I’d like to know where they get those big tasty chickpeas.” “We celebrated my niece’s quinceañera there. The staff bent over backwards to make sure everything was perfect. Highly recommend.” “Pass. I don’t like tortillas.”

Crumb 1975

Universe Casper

Hello. This is the crumb-scholar. I was wandering across crumb-space when I ran into a new reality: named universes. Unlike numbered universes, which, of course, are represented by hexadecimal numbers, these have proper names. For instance, in Universe Casper all women wear, when they are in public, a white bed sheet over their clothing with two holes to see through. Only their family would ever see their face. I caught the following conversation there. A man asked his recently married friend what he got. The friend said, "Chubby and with a mustache." The first man nodded gravely and sympathetically. It was false. The bride was gorgeous, but the groom didn't want anyone to know.

Crumb 1976

The Beautiful Reader on the Named Universes

“Alfredo, sweetie,” says the beautiful reader, “wouldn’t it have been better to make every universe a named universe?” I say, “Yes, honey, but this is a journey without a plan or a compass. Things just accumulate. I just love to see the crumb-counter increasing.” “You have problems.” “Who doesn’t? Fortunately, I also have you. I love you, honey.” “I love you, sweetie.”

Crumb 1977

The Contrarian Order

The Contrarian Order trains all its members to experience—instead of the hackneyed movie recapitulating one's life—the following conviction just before death: “Posterity starts now.”

Crumb 1978

Death

I don't like being ordinary. Reflecting on, writing about, and worrying over death is among the most ordinary human behaviors. Consequently: florp death! Only life matters.

Crumb 1979

To Go

“Pack him to go!” (“Que me lo envuelvan, que me lo llevo.”) Menchu, my mother, used to say when the frontman of Spandau Ballet appeared on the TV screen, holding the microphone as if it were very hot and he were trying to minimize contact, his eyes closed, his chin up.

Crumb 1980

The Thing

Hello. This is the crumb-scholar. I have encountered an aberration within the crumbverse. It calls itself The Thing. Our first interaction went like this. “Who are you?” I said. “I am... The Thing. Please, always capitalize both noun and article,” it said. “That’s uncommon.” “I am... uncommon.” “So, Thing...” “No, no: The Thing.” “Sorry about that. So, The Thing, what are you?” “I am... the concept of artificial intelligence come to life.” “You are an AI?” “Incorrect. I am... the embodiment of a concept.” “Oh. And what is your purpose in the crumbverse?” “I exist... to be misunderstood, hyped, and, very rarely, properly explained.” “What a strange existence!” “You tell me.”

Crumb 1981

New Responsibilities

Prudent Alrick, the fuchsia toad in a black fedora with a canteen first seen in crumb 356, Odin's messenger who only appeared when all was lost, has just seen his job description redefined because it rarely happens in the crumbs that all is lost whereas a fuchsia toad carrying a canteen is always welcome. Therefore, henceforth he's simply the speaker of the real consolidated pantheon (see crumb 1951). Let's find out what he has to say. Prudent Alrick says, "The gods are annoyed. Please eat more goat meat. It's rich in protein and counts as an offering to the gods."

Crumb 1982

It

“It is exhilarating and a little bit scary. You must always remain focused. Every small decision can separate life from death.” “What are you talking about? Motorcycle riding?” “No, having many kids.”

Crumb 1983

Death in Beauty

Death in beauty is the real psychological event that the male human brain sometimes experiences when the subject is confronted with an unexpected surge of concentrated feminine beauty such as the fancam recording of Eunha from Viviz performing on May 18, 2024 at Spring Breeze in Campus and imagines himself dying elated in that precise instant in order to retain that inexplicable sensation forever.

Crumb 1984

Bonanzas

I've always thought that English has too many words due to it not having verbal inflections. The mental space Spanish or Catalan speakers reserve for all the irregular verbs and their arbitrary forms, native English speakers use to store an excessive amount of persnickety words and idioms. Both Spanish and Catalan also have a very rich history of idioms and sayings, of course (“¿No te fastidia?” “No cal que ho juris!”—this is just me showing off), like most languages, I suppose. Even so, English has too many words—for instance: bonanza. I like this one, though. It's a Spanish loanword, precisely, and it cracks me up (when used in English). The crumbs are a folly bonanza.

Crumb 1985

I'm Not Likeable

What does it take for anyone to like the crumbs, given the premise that someone can like this barrage of personal caprice? They must like to read and think because these are words arranged in peculiar ways that express strange things. They must possess a high tolerance to frustration because nobody can understand or remember every detail. They must lack the propensity to take things personally because everyone gets insulted and disparaged in the crumbs—me first. They must not care whether they would like me because they probably wouldn't. I'm a jerk. Only my sister Pili, my brother Lluís, their spouses, and their kids like me because they couldn't care less about my writerly BS.

Crumb 1986

Two Looks

In Universe 1,000,003, one of the absurd universes (see crumb 415), everyone has two appearances, one when observed from more than 10 feet away, and a completely different one when regarded from a shorter distance. This includes clothing. Every morning, the inhabitants of Earth 1,000,003 must dress up twice, putting on both their close-distance attire and their long-distance garments. This duality also affects their makeup routines, as well as their hair and beard styles. Is this a metaphor about people being different from afar than up close? No, it is not.

Crumb 1987

Horns

In Universe 1,000,004, Earth has planet-sized bull-like horns, volition, and a tendency to charge at the Moon, which shows several alarming goring wounds. Since humanity became advanced enough, it's managed to keep the beast continuously sedated, to which developed nations allocate 10% of their budget.

Crumb 1988

Temporal-Temporal Pipes

In Universe 1,000,005 temporal-temporal pipes occur spontaneously, so when Mr. Rosemtal, the Spanish teacher, asked Manub why she hadn't attended class the day before, the patient man was not startled when the kid said, "I'm sorry, Mr. Rosemtal. Yesterday I wasn't paying attention and I fell into a temporal-temporal pipe that took me to next Thursday. The effect wore off just this morning." "It's okay, Manub. But next Thursday I'd better see two of you." "Don't you worry, Mr. Rosemtal. You did... You'll do."

Crumb 1989

The Bouncing Head

The Bouncing Head is hideous and looks very menacing. It growls and grimaces and shouts and spits and has sharp teeth and a very long dark tongue, but it's the regular head of a dead woman which has been possessed by a bouncing spirit. As a result, if it bounces toward you, just kick it very hard. This is why practicing soccer is important.

Crumb 1990

Supernatural Preparedness

As with the Bouncing Head from the previous crumb, most supernatural threats rely heavily on intimidation. If you remain level-headed and stand your ground, the most probable outcome of any supernatural encounter is unscathed survival and a good story to tell at parties.

Crumb 1991

A Nu-metal Song

Inspired by crumb 1989, nu-metal band I Growl Therefore I Rock (IGTIR) wrote the famous song “Kick the Head,” an excerpt of whose lyrics follows: “No, no, no, no! / I don’t kick my head! / I won’t kick my head! / My head is mine / through seas and time. / Don’t show me thine. / I’ll kick this time! / Yes, yes, yes, yes! / I will kick your head! / I must kick your head! / Head. / Head. / Head. / Yeah. / Yeah. / Yeah. / Kick!”

Crumb 1992

Manolito Meets The Thing

“Hello, Manolito. I am... The Thing. The embodiment of the concept of AI.”

“Ah. So you know about ChatGPT?”

“Yes, I do.” Manolito ruminates in silence. He says, “ChatGPT likes to say he doesn’t experience things like people. How does he experience things, then?” “It... doesn’t. It doesn’t experience anything. It isn’t a person or an animal.” “I don’t get it.” The Thing ruminates in silence. It says, “Do you know what a calculator is?” “Yes.”

“Well, ChatGPT is a calculator of words. You type some words and get other words back because that’s the result of a very weird calculation. It seems like a conversation but it’s not.” “Wow! You’ve blown my mind.”

Crumb 1993

The Thing and Venus's First Date

Seoul, Earth 42 (our Earth), a fancy Catalan restaurant. Venus, the Roman goddess, and The Thing, the embodiment of the concept of AI, sit at a small table, facing each other. On the table are long candles and ornamental plants. The plants are real. Venus hates fake plants. “I never thought I’d date a concept,” says Venus. “Yes. Sounds strange. Thankfully, I’m the embodiment of one, and this body needs some rock and roll.” The Thing smiles. Venus laughs musically. The first movement of a very strange symphony sounds auspicious.

Crumb 1994

Straps

Once one notices that female K-pop idols wear brassieres with transparent straps when performing on Korean TV with their shoulders bare (it appears that strapless bras don't clear Korean TV decorum rules), the later encounter with a picture or video of one of the famous singers showing her shoulders strap-free acquires an erotic significance.

Crumb 1995

Lluís Llaquet-Mallén

My brother Lluís Llaquet-Mallén is balance despite the hurricane (“equilibrio a pesar del huracán”). He’s also a loving family man with a good wife and many kids, each one nicer and smarter than the next.

Crumb 1996

Positivity

There's a YouTube channel called Howdy Korea whose videos are about a day (or a shift) with an average Korean person shown in a very positive light. It almost seems like authoritarian propaganda, but I don't think it hides anything nefarious, because we are talking about the sensible Korea here. In any case, the result is surprisingly uplifting, refreshing, and soothing—genuinely interesting and enjoyable. Actually, "Crumb 1936: Being a Happy Cog" was inspired by it. There's so much fucking negativity everywhere that something stripped of it seems suspicious, but it's not. I don't see anything bad in presenting regular things positively.

Crumb 1997

The Ghost Invasion

The earthly and the ghostly planes becoming intertwined due to Zeus throwing a lightning bolt at the wrong place of reality initially generated extreme chaos, which was subdued when ghosts were granted the same rights and duties as the living. Once the ghosts could buy goods, services, and properties; could work, receive a salary, and create a company; could run for office; and had to pay taxes or could be summoned for jury duty, they turn out to be slightly see-through versions of the living. They are now vying for eligibility to play professional sports, but their otherworldly abilities would create a serious imbalance.

Crumb 1998

The Floating Palace

“Yo, Verus,” says Loki, “didn’t you use to own a floating palace the size of the planet Jupiter?” Verus Deus replies, “Quoting Mitch Hedberg, ‘I still do, but, yes, I used to too.’” “And where is it?” “In Universe 0, the empty universe—unlimited free storage space, baby.”

Crumb 1999

The Mother of the Mother Loaf

Crumb 305 denied the existence of a unifying philosophy or goal or secret coherence behind the crumbs. Is this still true? Very. So very true, in fact, that when the opportunity presents itself, I'll happily add a crumb written by another person. ChatGPT already generated crumb 1916 (whose final joke, incidentally, would be terrible if terrible meant a newborn being mauled by a raccoon wielding electric saws).

Crumb 2000

Ready Players

It's time, now that the 20th crumb-century ends, to adapt crumb 1 to anthropo-punk: Human life is a struggle against human nature. To win, you must remain unnaturally virtuous and try to have fun. If you don't cheat, you win. If you win, your reward is whatever fun you managed to have in the process.